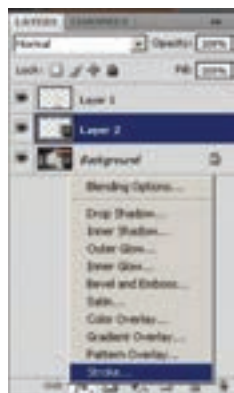


Performances tab, you will notice the default History states kept to 20. If you are working on high resolution images, and the number of history states is something like 30-40, then you do get lots of opportunities to undo a step that was done sometime back, but Photoshop performance will take a hit. So ideally, try to keep the History States to the minimum level to free up some memory resources.

Finally, though this may seem like



Adding the effects such as Stroke and Drop Shadow by clicking on the FX icon

stating the obvious, only keep those files open on which you are currently performing any tasks for the simple reason that each open image will use up some memory. More so if you perform some operation and then

forget about the image, the History and layers palette will use up more memory.

Faster Adobe Reader

Opening PDF files may take ages for some and this has prompted many users to switch to other readers like Foxit. But you can speed up the opening up of Adobe Reader quite easily. All you have to do is disable all the plug-ins.

Go to the plug_ins folder in Reader. The path in our case was something like this

C drive > Program Files
> Adobe > Reader 9.0 >
Reader > plug_ins

Move all the contents of your plug_ins folder to a backup folder somewhere on your hard drive. After the plug_ins folder is empty, try restarting that PDF file which took ages to open and notice how quick the reader opens that PDF file. Don't worry, the absence of default plug-ins will not affect your Reader performance. You can always paste back the plug_ins from the backup folder into its original folder, in case you notice any problems.

Creating a 3D pop out image

Using this tutorial you can make your subject stand out from the background. This 3D effect also looks very good in images that have some action going on like a moving car, sports etc. It makes use of a very good tool found in all version of Photoshop from CS3 onwards. Its called the Quick Selection Tool and is present along with the Magic Wand Tool. So without further ado, lets jump straight into the tutorial.

Step One : Open the image. Using the Quick Selection Tool (W), select the subject from the image that you want to make more prominent and want to give a 3D pop out effect. In our case our subject was the speeding car. We want to make it appear as if it is coming out of the scenery.

Once you have selected the subject, you may notice the selection tending to go beyond your subject. Hold on to the Alt key and try to clear the excess selection.

Step Two : Once the selection is made use Ctrl+J to put the selected image onto its own layer. (Layer 1)

Step Three : Select the background layer and click on the Rectangular Marquee Tool. Make a selection on the image, such that some portion of your subject is left outside the rectangular selection. This type of selection will get the subject out of the selected rectangular frame to which we will add some more effects to give it a 3D look.

After selecting the rectangular area, hit Ctrl+J to put this new selection on to its own layer. (Layer 2)

Step Four : Now staying on the Layer 2 as above click on the FX icon to open the Layer Style Menu. Then select the Stroke menu which can be found at the bottom of the list.

In the window that opens, keep the colour selected to white,

increase the Size of pixel and keep Position on Inside.

Go to the Outer Glow option in the Layer Style dialog box and increase Spread and Size. Keep the colour black. Blend Mode should be set to Multiply.

Step Five : After getting the frame around your subject select Layer 1. Go to FX icon > Drop Shadow. Apply the settings as seen in the Layers Style dialogue box on the previous page.

Step Six : Select the background layer and fill it with white colour. Press D+Ctrl+Backspace. This is the final result as seen on the previous page.

Colouring smoke in three quick steps

Smoke photography is quite a hobby and you will find lots of groups who post photographs of smoke and their editing with it. Adding colour to smoke is just one of the many things you can do with smoke. Instead of having a flat monotone in the smoke, you can have a range of colours as we will tell you how.

Step One : Take a photograph of image which has smoke element in it, such that the smoke is the main subject. Open a new file and drag your image file onto the new file, such that you have 2 layers.

Step Two : Now go to Image > Adjustments > Gradient Map. Select the black to white transition map such that your image appears like any other black and white image.

Step Three : Create a New Layer. Select Gradient Tool. Make your own preset in the Gradient Editor with the colours of your choice. The frame will be filled with the gradient colours. Select the Color mode for Layer 2, which will result in the image below. Create a duplicate layer and add Soft Light effect for an enhanced image.



The original image of the smoke



Psychedelic smoke after post processing